

a good buy for users needing good computing power while on the move.

**Price:** Rs 49,900

**Contact:** Nishubuki Computer Systems

**Phone:** 022-5825965

**Fax:** 022-5379719

**E-mail:** nishubuki@vsnl.com

#### SPECIFICATIONS

1 GHz Pentium III mobile processor, 192 MB RAM, 10 GB IBM hard disk drive, SiS 64 MB (shared) graphics card, 24x CD-ROM, four USB, one parallel, one COM and one infrared port

**Benchmarks:** 14.1 in Business Winstone 2001, 33 minutes in

BatteryMark 4.01, 13.5 in Content Creation 2001

**SiSoft benchmarks:** 111/113 MBps Memory ALU/FPU; 5 MBps in hard disk sequential read, 2.5 MBps in random read, 5 MBps in sequential write, 3.8 MBps in random write, average access time of 12 ms

Performance in *Quake III Arena*: sluggish and jerky but playable at 640x480

#### Nishubuki Desknote

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|-----------------|-------|
| Performance     | ▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Build quality   | ▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Value for money | ▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Features        | ▶▶▶▶▶ |
| <b>OVERALL</b>  | ▶▶▶▶▶ |

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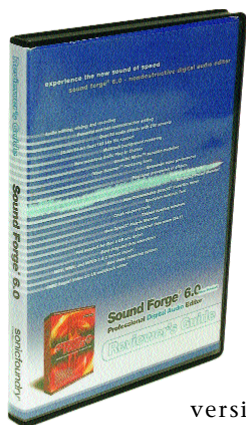
## Sound Forge 6.0

### Forging ahead

With this new release of Sound Forge, you can edit audio files onto the sample file with high speed and accuracy, without damaging the source file. The multitask background rendering feature also makes things faster as you can now work on one file while another is being rendered in the background.

Sound Forge 6.0 supports files larger than 4 GB and also includes the ability to record 32-bit files (192 KHz file support), ensuring pristine audio quality. Sound Forge 6.0 lets you open and edit MOV, WMA, WMV, MPEG1 and MPEG2 files, which means you can also edit video. Version 6.0 lets you burn CDs, so you don't need a separate software for this. Free Vegas Video 3.0 LE, a software bundled along with Sound Forge, allows you to mix audio and video using multiple tracks. It performs fast edits and applies effects and transitions. You can even hear and see the results in real-time.

The present interface is similar to the previous



version.

Professionals in the field of sound editing will find the new version worth upgrading to—it has a long list of new features and also lets you apply filter effects and edit sound a lot faster than you could ever before.

#### SPECIFICATIONS

200 MHz CPU, Windows-compatible soundcard, CD-ROM drive, supported CD-Recordable drive (only for burning CDs), 24-bit colour display recommended, 32 MB RAM, 25 MB hard disk space for program installation, Windows 98 SE/Me/2000/XP, Microsoft DirectX 8 or later

#### Sound Forge 6.0

|                 |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Performance     | ▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Ease of use     | ▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Value for money | ▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Features        | ▶▶▶▶▶ |
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**Price:** Rs 16,600

**Contact:** Pro-Music Inc

**Phone:** 044-8261445

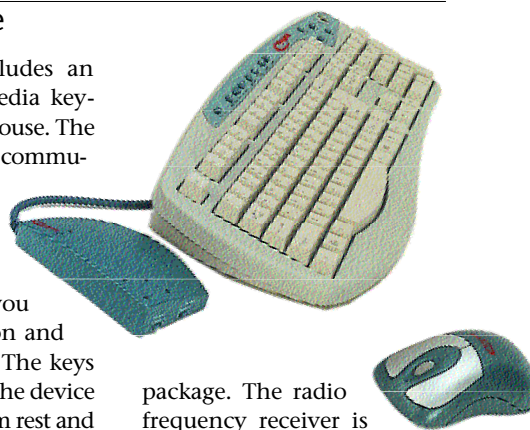
**Fax:** 044-8213607

**E-mail:** promusic@vsnl.com

## Typhoon wireless desktop

### A neat package

This package includes an Internet multimedia keyboard and a wheel mouse. The mouse and keyboard communicate with the PC using radio frequency through the provided receiver. The keyboard gives you good tactile sensation and is very comfortable. The keys are well laid out but the device doesn't include a palm rest and this could disappoint some users. There are 12 hotkeys on the keyboard aimed at speeding up your tasks. The keyboard is powered by two AA batteries, which are provided with the package. The Wheel 3D mouse also works on digital radio technology and features a noiseless scroll wheel. Its design is symmetrical, so both left and right-handed users should feel comfortable using it. The mouse is powered by two AAA batteries, which are also provided with the



package. The radio frequency receiver is easy to install—all you have to do is select the appropriate channel for the mouse and the keyboard and it's ready to be used. You can use the keyboard and mouse up to a distance of 10 feet—in our tests, the connection was lost when the distance was more.

#### PACKAGE CONTENTS

Mouse, keyboard, RF receiver, manual and the wireless desktop software

#### Typhoon wireless desktop

|                 |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Performance     | ▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Build quality   | ▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Value for money | ▶▶▶▶▶ |
| Features        | ▶▶▶▶▶ |
| <b>OVERALL</b>  | ▶▶▶▶▶ |

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## Umax Astra Slim 600

### A sleek scanner

Here's another scanner from the Umax stables. It comes in a blue-grey colour combination and has a USB interface, and a height of just over an inch. It can be powered directly from the USB interface without an external adapter. It can be completely managed through the bundled software by means of just a single button on the panel.

In our tests, it managed to preview a page in 26.94 seconds. But it took very long (119 seconds) to scan a full-page colour photograph at 300 dpi. In the image quality eval-



uation test, the results were quite stunning as the scanner scored 21 points out of a maximum of 29. The colour reproduction was pretty good too—the scanner picked up almost all the shades quite well.

However it was poor at picking up details. In the resolution test where five blocks of